"Someone joining Ceat or Zensar (both owned by RPG Enterprises) today needs a very different toolkit than, say, five years ago," says Goenka, adding that technology cycles—especially data automation and now AI—have compressed the shelf life of technical skills.

According to Ashok Ramachandran, Director (HR), Aditya Birla Group, businesses are evolving to bring in sharper consumer focus, deeper digital adoption and stronger innovation.

"We increasingly need fungible talent: people who can move across contexts, connect the dots between market shifts and translate strategy into outcomes," says Ramachandran. Here, a management graduate who understands core business fundamentals with digital fluency is a prized asset. "That person can add disproportionate value early by virtue of operating at the intersection of functions rather than working in silos," he adds.



Today, our focus is on identifying adaptability. Can this person take decisions? Or how well can he or she integrate relevant digital tools and collaborate with a multi-generational team"

ANANT GOENKA
VICE CHAIRMAN, RPG ENTERPRISES

THE REAL DISRUPTION

The question now is: how do companies balance multiple issues to choose the best minds?

According to Saurabh Chhajer, MD & Partner, Recruitment Lead, Boston Consulting Group India, the fundamental skill sets that his company looks for have not changed, but the context in which they are applied has.

What has not changed are intellectual curiosity, structured problem solving, leadership, communication and the ability to collaborate with different people. The big change is the environment where these skills are being applied, and in the levels of expectations.

According to Chhajer, that would mean "being familiar with what technology can do, being able to reimagine processes and business models with AI, apart from anticipating execution

THE TOP FIVE B-SCHOOLS

• **Four of the top five B-schools— IIM-A, IIM-C, IIM-L and SPJIMR—have retained 2025-26 ranks**

Rank 2026-27	Rank 2025-26		Institute	City	Learning Experience (250)	Living Experience (150)
1	1	⬌	Indian Institute of Management Ahmedabad (IIMA)	Ahmedabad	217.4	141.9
2	2	⬌	Indian Institute of Management Calcutta (IIMC)	Kolkata	210.8	140.8
3	3	⬌	Indian Institute of Management Lucknow (IIML)	Lucknow	204.3	136.5
4	4	⬌	S. P. Jain Institute of Management & Research (SPJIMR)	Mumbai	209.1	128.3
5	6	⬆	XLRI—Xavier School of Management	Jamshedpur	200.4	132.1